

December

29

2008

Worthy winners

In the USA, the Canadian Montreal Canadiens beat the US Florida Panthers, becoming the first ice hockey team in NHL history to win 3,000 regular-season games.



Also on this day

1860 Built for the British Royal Navy, the mighty HMS *Warrior* was launched – one of the first armour-plated, iron-hulled warships.

1922 Canadian-American teenager Aloha Wanderwell set off to become the first woman to circle the globe in a Ford 1918 Model T.

1937 The Irish Free State was renamed Ireland with the adoption of a new constitution.

Master of his craft

Dutch painter Johannes Vermeer registered as a master painter. Much of his artistic training remains a mystery. He would later go on to paint the famous *Girl with a Pearl Earring*.



1653



Dynamic duo

When *Flying Down to Rio* was released, it featured Fred Astaire and Ginger Rogers dancing together for the first time. The pair went on to star in some of the most glamorous Hollywood musicals of their time.

1933

Born this day

1766 Charles Macintosh, Scottish inventor. He is known for inventing waterproof fabric and the Mackintosh raincoat is named after him.

1981 Shizuka Arakawa, Japanese figure skater. She was the first Japanese skater to win an Olympic gold medal.